

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Board: 1
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠2

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠4

Board: 4
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦4

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥2

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 6
 ♥ 9 8 4 3
 ♦ 10 8 6
 ♣ K 10 7 6

♠ A J 10 7

♥ J 7

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ A 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 4 3 2

♥ A 6 2

♦ 7 4 2

♣ Q J 9 5

♠ Q 9 8 5

♥ K Q 10 5

♦ A K 3

♣ 4 2

With 14 points, ♣ shortage, and support for the other suits SOUTH makes a Takeout Double.

NORTH has 13 points so she bids 2♣. This is an artificial bid, apprising SOUTH of NORTH's opening hand strength, and forcing the partnership to reach the game level.

SOUTH suggests ♥s as trumps. NORTH doesn't like ♥s so she suggests ♠s. SOUTH agrees with ♠s and bids game, 4♠.

West	North	East	South
		1♣	Dbl
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♣Q			

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 7 4
 ♥ 9 6 5 2
 ♦ Q 5
 ♣ A 8 6 3

♠ 10 5

♥ K Q J 3

♦ 9 7 6 4

♣ Q 10 9



♠ A K J 9 8 3

♥ 7

♦ A K J 3

♣ 7 5

♠ 6 2

♥ A 10 8 4

♦ 10 8 2

♣ K J 4 2

SOUTH's 1♥ opening is passed around to EAST. He is tempted to overcall 1♠, but with 18 points is a little strong for a mere overcall. Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points WEST is not strong enough to jump. She bids 2♣.

EAST now bids 2♠. By doubling first, then bidding his own suit, he shows a good suit and 17+ points.

WEST raises to 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	Pass	Dbl	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by East			
Lead: ♠2			

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 6 5 4

♥ J 10 4

♦ K 10 9

♣ J 10 2

♠ 8 7

♥ A 9 7 6

♦ A 6 2

♣ K 9 6 3



♠ Q 10 3 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ J 8 5 3

♣ 7 4

♠ A J 9

♥ K Q 8

♦ Q 7 4

♣ A Q 8 5

SOUTH has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT. For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

NORTH bids 2♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When SOUTH denies holding a 4-card Major NORTH has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper since SOUTH promised he had the suit controlled.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♠	1NT
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♠ 4			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 6
 ♥ K Q J
 ♦ A J 9 7
 ♣ K Q 4

♠ 7 4 3

♥ A 8 3

♦ 5 4 3 2

♣ 10 7 5



♠ J 10 5 2

♥ 7 6 4 2

♦ 8 6

♣ J 8 6

♠ K Q 9

♥ 10 9 5

♦ K Q 10

♣ A 9 3 2

WEST has 20 points, excellent ♦ stoppers and a balanced hand. She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT. Instead, she doubles.

EAST has an awful hand - but since he is forced to bid he says 1♠, assuming WEST wants to hear his best suit.

WEST now bids 1NT, showing the balanced 19-21 point hand. EAST passes, of course.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♦
Dbl	Pass	1♠	Pass
1NT			
All Pass			
1NT by West			
Lead: ♦4			

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 10 3

♥ 9 7 4 3

♦ 10 9 2

♣ Q 5 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A Q 10

♦ K J 7 5

♣ A K 6



♠ 9 8 5

♥ K J 8 2

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 10 3

♠ K J 6 2

♥ 6 5

♦ A Q 3

♣ 9 8 7 4

NORTH has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in ♥s. He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

SOUTH has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2♠.

In theory NORTH could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well go ahead and bid 3NT instead.

West

1♥

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥2

North

Dbl

3NT

East

Pass

South

2♠